

while doing all the work intuitively. And it has to do all of that while being light and efficient. It's why WinAmp has so many more followers than a Windows Media Player or iTunes.

On the mobile phone side of things, KD Player has been the king of this sector. The program is meant primarily for regular Java-based phones, although it will work on most Windows Mobile and other high-end smartphones. If you are using a handset with a screen resolution no bigger than 240x320 pixels, this is the player to use.

KD Player does nothing that can be considered out of the ordinary. You install the small file (less than 150KB) and start it up to see a simple interface that users of Sony Ericsson phones will especially find quite homely.

Hit the Menu button and browse to where you have all your songs stored. KD Player will scan the folder and put your tracks in its library for easy access.

The support for ID3 tags is a boon, as you do not have to spend any time renaming your files. And if you have added album artwork to the ID3 of the music file, KD Player can read and display that too. Alternately, artwork from the album's folder can also be shown on screen.

Once you start the song, KD Player has a simple interface that shows the artist's name; the album; the track title; its duration along with a progression bar; and the bit rate at which it is playing. The '4', '5' and '6' keys on your keypad can be used for previous track/rewind; play/pause; and next track/forward respectively.

You can also create playlists with KD Player, and save them for future use.

The best part, though, is that it can run safely in the background without taking up too much RAM. We recommend you assign a hotkey for the player if your phone allows for it. This way, you can fire it up when necessary, make the necessary changes, and minimise it to continue with your work. KD Player can also access the dedicated music keys on most phones.

The player is extremely popular online, so you can find a lot of help, tips and tricks regarding it. A little bit of searching will also throw up various skins and skin packs to jazz up the looks.

So pop in those earphones, sit back and enjoy!